

that the advisor is not providing truly unbiased advice.

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3. You received no written financial plan, prospectus, or documentation.

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Every investment product should be accompanied by a detailed written description of the investment, including its composition, historical performance, and inherent risks and rewards. This is generally covered in the prospectus, which is a bare minimum of what you should receive. Better yet, you should also be given a *written financial plan*, which addresses your personal financial situation and outlines a financial road map to reaching your short- and long-term goals.

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4. You are pressured into making investments.

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Although sitting on the fence forever is an advisor's nightmare, and sometimes clients need a little extra push, undue pressure into doing something you are uncomfortable with is not right. Even if the recommendations are sound, if you get bad vibes from high-pressure sales tactics, your ability to communicate with this advisor and for them to listen to your needs

is going to be problematic going forward.

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5. Your planner's recommendations don't match your financial goals.

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You say you want to save up to buy a house, and your advisor recommends high-risk long-term investments. Something is not jiving here, and it is likely that they are either not listening to your needs, or are not acting in your best interest.

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6. You can never reach your advisor when you want to, and they don't return your phone calls.

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With an onset of statement shock, you need to talk to somebody. Often big problems and feelings of discomfort can be alleviated with a simple phone call and a reassurance that staying the course is the best thing to do. But if you can never reach your advisor, if they pawn you off on an assistant, or if they don't return your phone calls promptly, they are not doing their job.

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7. They constantly change your investments.

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Seeing a regular list of transactions coming through may lead you to be-